
BRAND VISUAL MOOD BOARD / 2026

The Modern Tea Artisan.

A visual direction for Chi Cha San Chen in North America.

Prepared by Rooster Creatives
For TC Chen & Connie Chuang, Chi Cha San Chen
May 2026

A quiet brand in a loud market.

While North American tea brands compete on color, noise, and novelty, Chi Cha San Chen earns attention by doing the opposite — slowing down, leaving space, and letting craft speak for itself.

EDITORIAL

Treat every post like a page from *Kinfolk* or *Cereal* — composition, light, and silence as design tools.

CRAFT

Show the hands, the leaves, the process. The brand's strongest story is one no machine can tell.

STILLNESS

In a feed of motion and color, calm is the loudest voice. Negative space is the brand's signature.

“Don't compete with the noise. Become the quiet alternative.”

Earth, leaf, and warm light.

A low-saturation palette drawn from the tea itself — fresh leaves, oxidized liquor, linen, and afternoon sun. Designed to feel calm beside the rest of the feed.

PRIMARY / CORE BRAND COLORS



DEEP TEA

#2C3E2D

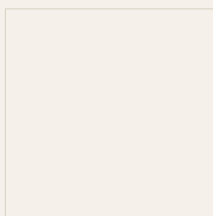
Primary brand color ·
backgrounds, headlines



MOSS

#5C6B4F

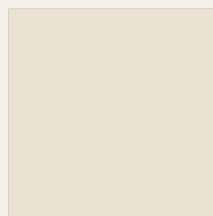
Secondary green ·
supporting tones



CREAM

#F5F1EA

Page background · max
negative space



PARCHMENT

#EBE3D2

Soft accent · supporting
backgrounds



WARM GOLD

#B08D57

Highlights, dividers, key
accents

SECONDARY / WARM ACCENTS & SUPPORTING TONES



COPPER

#A6633A

Seasonal accent ·
autumn campaigns



TEA LIQUOR

#8B7355

Beverage-led visuals,
brewing scenes



CHARCOAL

#2B2B2B

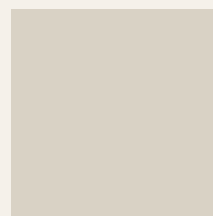
Body text · primary copy



MUTED

#6B6B6B

Captions, secondary
copy



DIVIDER

#D9D2C5

Hairline rules, soft
borders

RULE OF THREE — no single image should use more than three palette colors. Restraint is the design.

Serif gravity, sans-serif clarity.

An editorial pairing — a confident serif for headlines and stories, a clean sans-serif for everyday speech. Always generous in spacing and line height.

DISPLAY / HEADLINE SERIF

The Tea Master

Recommended: Playfair Display · GT Sectra · Reckless Neue

Use for hero headlines, campaign titles, and key brand statements.

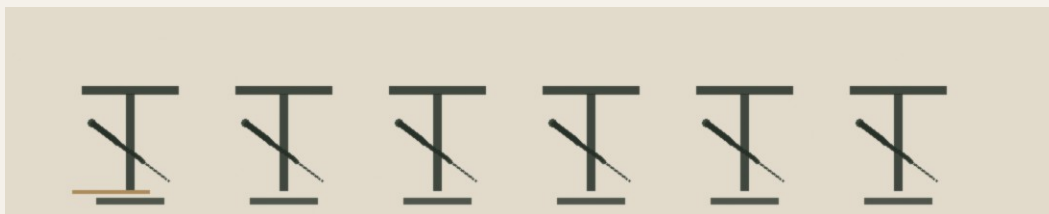
BODY / SANS-SERIF

Three thousand leaves, carefully selected. Hand-shaken, every time.

Recommended: Inter · Söhne · Neue Haas Grotesk · Aktiv Grotesk

Use for captions, in-feed copy, product descriptions, and navigation.

TRADITIONAL CHINESE PAIRING



Recommended: Source Han Serif · GenYoMin · JinXuan · Noto Serif TC.

Editorial Ming-style serifs preferred over rounded or playful fonts. Reserve script and calligraphy for special campaigns only.

- Generous line-height (1.5×–1.8×). Let copy breathe.
- Left-aligned or centered — never justified.
- Hierarchy through size and weight, not color.
- Never use more than two typefaces in one composition.

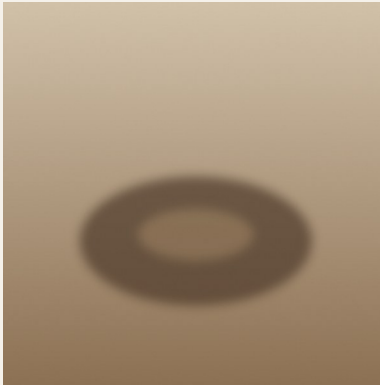
Six frames, one feeling.

Every Chi Cha San Chen image should fall into one of six categories — and feel like it could appear on a magazine spread.



01 THE LEAVES

Tea leaves on linen, natural light, shallow depth of field. Treats tea like specialty coffee beans.



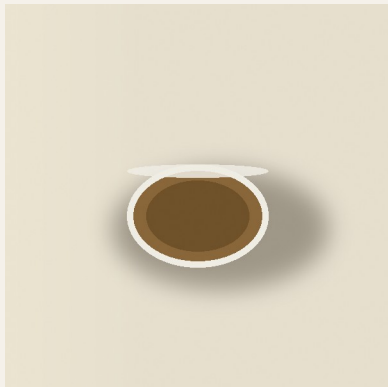
02 THE HANDS

Tea master's hands — pouring, shaking, sifting. Never reveal the full face. The action is the subject.



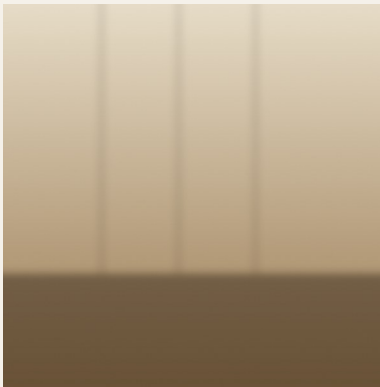
03 THE POUR

Decisive moments: liquid mid-air, steam, the first contact with the cup. ASMR in still form.



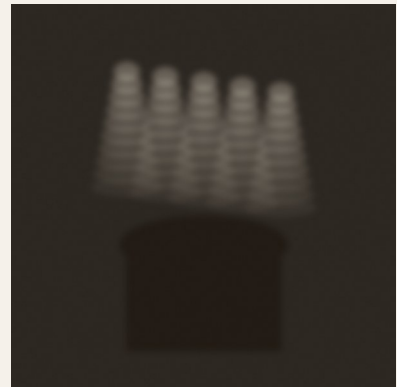
04 THE STILL LIFE

Finished tea, top-down or 45°, isolated on a textured surface. Hero shot, editorial mood.



05 THE LIGHT

Afternoon light through a window, a customer in profile, a quiet moment. Mood over message.



06 THE RITUAL

Tools and pots — the equipment of craft. Suggests heritage and discipline, never excess.

A feed with rhythm.

Three content pillars rotate across the grid — image, story, image — so the feed reads like an editorial layout, not a product catalog.



- | | |
|---------------------|--|
| — The Tea | <i>Stories about leaves, origin, season.</i> |
| — The Hands | <i>Process, craft, and the people behind the tea.</i> |
| — The Moment | <i>Customer life, the ritual of drinking tea.</i> |
| — Editorial Posters | <i>Brand voice in pure typography — 2–3 per month.</i> |

Confident. Quiet. Poetic.

We don't sell drinks — we offer a pause. Captions should read like the opening line of an essay, not the close of a sales pitch.

AVOID

“[fire emoji] NEW DROP! Brown Sugar Boba
BUY 1 GET 1! Hurry, while supplies last [eyes
emoji] #boba #bubbletea #tealover
#bubbleteaholic #boomtea #drinkoftheday”

WRITE LIKE THIS

*Spring tea has arrived.
Picked at dawn in Lugu Township.
A small batch. A slow afternoon.*

VOICE ATTRIBUTES

ATTRIBUTE	YES	NO
Pace	Slow	<i>Hurried</i>
Mood	Reflective	<i>Excited</i>
Length	Short, spare	<i>Long, salesy</i>
Authority	Calm confidence	<i>Loud claims</i>
Punctuation	Minimal	<i>Emoji-heavy</i>
Language	Prose, poetic	<i>Hashtag stacks</i>

The brands we'd sit beside.

Inspiration drawn not from tea brands, but from the editorial, hospitality, and lifestyle worlds. This is the company Chi Cha San Chen should aspire to keep visually.

BEVERAGE / COFFEE

Blue Bottle Coffee	@bluebottle	<i>Editorial product photography, minimal feeds, white space</i>
% Arabica	@arabica.coffee	<i>Architectural restraint, monochrome, lifestyle as art</i>
Postcard Teas	@postcardteas	<i>Tea-leaf photography elevated to specialty-coffee territory</i>

EDITORIAL / LIFESTYLE

Kinfolk	@kinfolk	<i>The gold standard for negative space and tonal restraint</i>
Cereal Magazine	@cerealmag	<i>Travel-mag aesthetic — moody, slow, architectural</i>
Aesop	@aesopskincare	<i>Apothecary minimalism, serif typography, atmospheric color</i>

ASIAN HERITAGE / CRAFT

Nakamura Tea	@nakamura.tea	<i>Japanese craft tea brand — luxury packaging, ritual photography</i>
Ippodo Tea	@ippodotea_japan	<i>Centuries-old tea house with modern restraint</i>
In Tea	@in_tea_brand	<i>Modern Asian tea brand with strong editorial direction</i>

The shape of our restraint.

Holding the line is harder than starting it. These are the temptations to resist.

DO

— Generous negative space

At least 30% of every composition should breathe.

— Natural light only

Window light, afternoon glow, soft shadows.

— Hands, not faces

Show the craft, never the salesperson.

— Serif headlines

Times Roman, Playfair, Sectra — never display-script.

— One product, one frame

If two drinks appear in a photo, one too many.

— Slow captions

Two short lines often beats a paragraph.

DON'T

— Loud emoji stacks

[stacked emojis] — never. Use sparingly, never decoratively.

— Neon colors / gradients

Save bright colors for competitors.

— Stock-photo lifestyles

Posed laughter, group selfies, fake candid.

— Cartoon mascots

Leave the cute play to Mixue and CoCo.

— Buy-one-get-one shouting

Promos exist — they don't have to scream.

— Hashtag walls

Limit to 4–6 considered tags, not 30.

FINAL WORD

*“A tea is brewed once.
A brand is brewed every day.”*

Next: this mood board becomes a Brand Visual Guide — token-by-token rules for the team, the regional accounts, and any partners we bring on.

Rooster Creatives

Travis · Jessica · Mynor · Cath (Taiwan)

Prepared for Chi Cha San Chen, May 2026.